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Professional Appointments

- 2026 – present Associate Professor, Department of Psychology, The University of Texas at Austin
UT Research Center affiliations:
2022 – present: *Texas Behavioral Science and Policy Institute (TxBSPI)*;
2022 – present: *UT Austin NLP and Computational Linguistics group*
- 2022 – 2026 Assistant Professor, Department of Psychology, The University of Texas at Austin
- 2019 – 2022 Assistant Professor, Department of Information Systems and Analytics,
School of Computing, National University of Singapore
NUS Research Center affiliations:
2019 – 2022: *NUS Artificial Intelligence Lab*;
2020 – 2022: *Institute for Applied Learning Sciences and Educational Technology (ALSET)*;
2021 – 2022: *Centre for Trusted Internet and Community*; *Institute of Data Science*
- 2017 – 2022 Research Scientist
Institute of High Performance Computing (IHPC),
Agency for Science, Technology and Research (A*STAR), Singapore
(From 2019–2022, I held a minority-time appointment at A*STAR)

Education

- 2017 Ph.D., Psychology (Cognitive Psychology and Affective Science), Stanford University
- 2017 M.S., Computer Science (Specialization in Artificial Intelligence), Stanford University
- 2014 M.A., Psychology, Stanford University
- 2011 B.A., Economics (*summa cum laude*; top in class),
and Physics (*magna cum laude*; top three in class),
with minors in Cognitive Studies; and in Information Science,
Cornell University

Awards, Honors, Fellowships

- 2026 Google Higher Ed Faculty AI Fellow
- 2026 Early Career Award, Society for Affective Science
- 2025 Josh Holahan Department of Psychology Excellence in Teaching Award, The University of Texas at Austin
- 2025 NSF CAREER Award, National Science Foundation
- 2025 Editor's Choice Award, Psychological Review
- 2022 Best of IEEE Transactions on Affective Computing 2021 Paper Collection
- 2022 Faculty Teaching Excellence Award, National University of Singapore
- 2021 Best Paper Award, IEEE Affective Computing and Intelligent Interaction 2021

Research Grants

Desmond C. Ong, Ph.D.

12. "Representative Sample of Chatlogs of People Using AI for Mental Health Needs"
OpenAI AI and Mental Health Grant Program (Dec 2025).
2026 – 2027. Role: "Co-PI"
11. "Characterizing Delusional Spirals through Human-LLM Chat Logs & Clinical Precursors"
OpenAI AI and Mental Health Grant Program (Dec 2025).
2026 – 2027. Role: "Co-PI"
10. "CAREER: HCC: Quantifying Social and Affective Cognition in Humans and Machines"
Research Project (CAREER award) funded by the National Science Foundation
2025 – 2030. Role: Principal Investigator.
9. "Large Language Models and Digital Empathy"
Research project funded by Microsoft Research's AI, Cognition, and the Economy (AICE)
Accelerator Pilot Collaborations
2023 – 2025. Role: Principal Investigator.
8. "The ConnectTown: Building empathy and community through sharing experiences"
Research project sponsored by Toyota Research Institute
2023 – 2026. Role: Principal Investigator.
7. "The "Other Me": Human-Centered AI Assistance In Situ"
AI Singapore Research Grant Call (to PI: D. Hsu).
2021 – 2025. Role: Co-Principal Investigator (2021–2022), Collaborator (from 2022)
6. "Developing Capabilities in AI Modelling of Social and Affective Behaviour"
Ministry of Education Academic Research Fund Tier 1 (NUS Startup Grant)
2019 – 2022. Role: Principal Investigator
5. "Assistive AI with Artificial Theories of Mind and Body"
AI Singapore Grant Call (to PI: H. Soh)
2019 – 2022. Role: Collaborator
4. "Semantic and Map-lite Indoor Visual Navigation"
National Robotics Programme (to PI: K.W. Wan)
2019 – 2021, extended to 2022. Role: Co-Investigator
3. "Scalable Mindset Interventions to Nurture Strategic, Self-Regulated Learners"
Singapore Millennium Foundation Grant (to PI: P. Chen)
2018 – 2021. Role: Interdisciplinary Collaborator
2. "Human-Centric AI (CHEEM) Research Project"
A*STAR Science and Engineering Research Council
(to Programme Managers K. Kwok, C. Tan)
2017 – 2020. Role: Work Package Lead
1. "Computational and brain predictors of emotion cue integration"
National Institutes of Health 1R01MH112560-01 (to PI: J. Zaki)
2017 – 2022. Role: Other Significant Contributor (key personnel)

Publications

Links to sortable lists of publications (by discipline/topic), and associated code and data, can be found on my website.

Italicized indicates trainees (who I helped advised / trained, including informally).

White papers and policy documents

- **Ong, D. C.**, Moore, J., Martinez-Martin, N., Meinhardt, C., Lin, E., & Agnew, W. (2025). Response to FDA's Request for Public Comment on Measuring and Evaluating AI-enabled Medical Device Performance in the Real World.
<https://hai.stanford.edu/policy/response-to-fdas-request-for-comment-on-ai-enabled-medical-devices>
[Covered in Forbes]

Research Articles

82. **Ong, D. C.**, Goldenberg, A., Inzlicht, M., & Perry, A. (2026). AI-Generated Empathy: Opportunities, limits, and future directions. *Current Directions in Psychological Science*.
81. **Ong, D. C.** (2026). Friendlier LLMs tell users what they want to hear — even when it is wrong. *Nature* **652**, 1134-1135.
80. Moore, J., Mehta, A., Agnew, W., Anthis, J. R., Louie, R., Mai, Y., Yin, P., Cheng, M., Paech, S., Klyman, K., Chancellor, S., Lin, E., Haber, N., & **Ong, D. C.** (2026). Characterizing Delusional Spirals through Human-LLM Chat Logs. In *2026 ACM Conference on Fairness, Accountability, and Transparency (FAccT)*, 7631–7674.
79. Munin, S., Jurkiewicz, O., Gueorguieva, E., Oveis, C., & **Ong, D. C.** (2026). What Can I say to Help You? Language Associated with Successful Extrinsic Emotion Regulation. *Emotion*, 26 (4), 849–859.
78. Yang, Y., Schoenwald, S. K., Moore, J., **Ong, D. C.**, Liu, X., & Hancock, J. T. (2026). AI-Induced Delusional Spirals: Understanding Lived Experiences During Maladaptive Human-Chatbot Interactions. In *Proceedings of the 2026 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems*.
77. Mehta A., Moore, J., Anthis, J. R., Agnew, W., Lin, E., Yin, P., **Ong, D. C.**, Haber, N., & Dweck, C. (2026). The Dynamics of Delusion: Modeling Bidirectional False Belief Amplification in Human-Chatbot Dialogue. In *Proceedings of the 48th Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society*.
76. Cheng, M., Sieh, I., Zope, H., Yu, S., Ibrahim, L., Arora, A., Moore, J., **Ong, D. C.**, Jurafsky, D., & Yang, D. (2026). Verbalizing LLMs' assumptions to explain and control sycophancy. In *Proceedings of the 3rd Conference on Language Modeling (COLM)*.
75. Feuerriegel, S., Barrie, C., Crockett, M. J., ... **Ong, D. C.**, ... & Ribeiro, M. H. (2026). A consensus-based reporting checklist for Large Language Models in behavioral and social science. *Nature Human Behaviour*.
74. Preece, D. A., Mehta A., Wurgaft, D., Levy, C., Spink, K. M., Teo, Q. K., Jiang, Y., **Ong, D. C.**, Chen, P., Bratman, G. H., & Gross, J. J. (in press). Alexithymia and Ill- and Well-being: The Role of Emotion Regulation. *Emotion*.
73. Suh, J., Le, L., Shavegani, E., Ramos, G., Amores, J., **Ong, D. C.**, Czerwinski, M. & Hernandez, J. (2026). SENSE-7: Taxonomy and Dataset for Measuring User Perceptions of Empathy in Sustained Human-AI Conversations. *IEEE Transactions on Affective Computing*, 17 (2), 2227–2244.
72. Girard, J. M., Jun, D., **Ong, D. C.**, Liebenthal, E., & Baker, J. T. (2026). Sentiment Analysis of Naturalistic Speech using Open-Weight Large Language Models. *Affective Science*, 7 (2), 166–180.
71. Nowicki, F., Marciniak, H., Łączkowski, J., Wilczek, B., Jassem, K., Górecki, T., Balakrishnan, V., **Ong, D.** & Behnke, M. (2026). Visual Affect Analysis: Predicting Emotions of Image Viewers with Vision-Language Models. In *2026 14th International Conference on Affective Computing and Intelligent Interaction (ACII)*.

70. Doan, T., **Ong, D. C.**, & Wu, Y. (2025). Emotion understanding as third-person appraisals: Integrating appraisal theories with developmental theories of emotion. *Psychological Review*, 132(1), 130–153.
[Editor's Choice Award]
** This was an equally-co-conceptualized idea reflected in the theoretical content (and the CRediT statement), even if not with official equal contribution notes.*
69. Moore, J., Grabb, D., Agnew, W., Klyman, K., Chancellor, S., **Ong, D. C.***, & Haber, N.* (2025). Expressing stigma and inappropriate responses prevent LLMs from safely replacing mental health providers. In *2025 ACM Conference on Fairness, Accountability, and Transparency (FAccT)*.
** Equal Contribution*
68. Hecht, C. A.*, **Ong, D. C.***, Clapper, M., Jones, M., Demszky, D., Yang, D., Eichstaedt, J., Bryan, C. J., & Yeager, D. S. (2025). Using Large Language Models in Behavioral Science Interventions: Promise and Risk. *Behavioral Science & Policy*, 11(1), 1–9
** Equal Contribution*
67. Chen, P., Teo, Q. K., Foo, D. X. Y., Jiang, Y., Sun, L., Ong, X. L., Neo, D., Pereira, D. J. H., Tan, B., Chua, K. Q., Gan, J. X. F., & **Ong, D. C.** (2025). A Strategic Mindset Predicts and Promotes Effective Learning and Academic Performance. *npj Science of Learning*, 10 (74).
66. Choudhury, M., Elyoseph, Z., Fast, N. J., **Ong, D. C.**, Nsoesie, E. O. & Pavlick, E. (2025). The Promise and Pitfalls of Generative AI. *Nature Reviews Psychology*, 4, 75–80.
(All authors contributed equally and listed in alphabetical order; invited submission)
65. Munin, S., **Ong, D. C.**, Okland, S., Freedman, G., & Beer, J. S. (2025). Language Measures Correlate With Other Measures Used to Study Emotion. *Communications Psychology*, 3, 29.
64. Reddan, M., **Ong, D. C.**, Wager, T. D., Mattek, S., Kahhale, I., & Zaki, J. (2025). Neural signatures of emotional intent and inference align during social consensus. *Nature Communications*, 16, 6156.
63. Rubin, M., Li, J., Zimmerman, F., **Ong, D. C.**, Goldenberg, A., & Perry, A. (2025). Comparing the Value of Perceived Human versus AI-Generated Empathy. *Nature Human Behaviour*.
62. Jiang, K., Smith-Flores, A., Liang, K., **Ong, D. C.**, & Powell, L. J. (2025). Vicarious emotion predictions integrate information about relationship strength. In *Proceedings of the 47th Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society*, 372–378.
61. Zhou*, Y., Xu*, H., **Ong, D. C.**, Liakata, M., Slovak, P. & He, Y. (2025). Modeling Subjectivity in Cognitive Appraisal with Language Models. In *Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics: EMNLP 2025*.
60. Yeo, G., & **Ong, D. C.** (2024). Associations Between Cognitive Appraisals and Emotions: A Meta-Analytic Review. *Psychological Bulletin*, 150(12), 1440–1471.
59. Zhan, H., Zheng, A., Lee, Y. K., Suh, J., Li, J. J., & **Ong, D. C.** (2024). Large Language Models are Capable of Offering Cognitive Reappraisal, if Guided. In *Proceedings of the 1st Conference on Language Modeling (COLM)*.
58. Lee, Y. K., Suh, J., Zhan, H., Li, J. J., & **Ong, D. C.** (2024). Large Language Models produce responses perceived to be empathic. In *Proceedings of the 12th IEEE International Conference on Affective Computing and Intelligent Interaction (ACII)*.
57. **Ong, D. C.** (2024). GPT-ology, Computational Models, Silicon Sampling: How should we think about LLMs in Cognitive Science? In *Proceedings of the 46th Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society*, 3968–3975.
56. **Ong, D. C.**, Zhi-Xuan, T., Tenenbaum, J. B., & Goodman, N. D. (2024). Probabilistic Programming versus Meta-Learning as Models of Cognition. *Behavioral and Brain Sciences*, 47, e158. (Commentary).

55. Goel, S., Jara-Ettinger, J., **Ong, D. C.**, & Gendron, M. (2024). Face and context integration in emotion inferences is limited and variable across categories and individuals. *Nature Communications*, 15, 2443.
54. Gueorguieva, E. S., Lau, T., Hadjiandreou, E., & **Ong, D. C.** (2024). The Language of an Empathy-Inducing Narrative. In *Proceedings of the 46th Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society*, 2132–2139.
53. Kade, S. A., du Toit, S. A., Danielson, C. T., Schweizer, S., Morrison, A. S., **Ong, D. C.**, Prasad, A., Holder, L. J., Han, J., Torok, M., & Wong, Q. J. J. (2024). Aberrant cognitive empathy in individuals with elevated social anxiety and regulation with emotional working memory training. *Cognition and Emotion*. 38, 4, 605–623.
52. Kahlale, I., Barry, R. K., **Ong, D. C.**, Zaki, J., & Hanson, J. L., (2024). Exploring the Role of Empathy in the Association Between Early Life Adversity and Antisocial Behavior. *Affective Science*, 6, 128–144
51. Suh, J., Pendse, S. R., Lewis, R., Howe, E., Saha, K., Okoli, E., Amores, J., Ramos, G., Shen, J., Borghouts, J., Sharma, A., Pedrelli, P., Friedman, L., Jackman, C., Benhalim, Y., **Ong, D. C.**, Segal, S., Althoff, T., & Czerwinski, M. (2024). Rethinking Technology Innovation for Mental Health: Framework for Multi-Sectoral Collaboration. *Nature Mental Health*, 2, 478–488.
50. Demszky*, D., Yang*, D., Yeager*, D. S., Bryan, C. J., Clapper, M., Chandhok, S., Eichstaedt, J. C., Hecht, C., Jamieson, J., Johnson, M., Jones, M., Krettek-Cobb, D., Lai, L., JonesMitchell, N., **Ong, D. C.**, Dweck^, C. S., Gross^, J. J., & Pennebaker^, J. W. (2023). Using Large Language Models in Psychology. *Nature Reviews Psychology*, 2, 688–701
* equal contribution, ^ equal contribution
49. Zhan, H., **Ong, D. C.**, & Li, J. J. (2023). Evaluating Subjective Cognitive Appraisals of Emotions from Large Language Models. In *Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics: EMNLP 2023*.
48. Genzer, S.*, **Ong, D. C.***, Zaki, J., & Perry, A. (2022). Mu rhythm suppression over sensorimotor regions is associated with greater empathic accuracy. *Social Cognitive and Affective Neuroscience*, 17(9), 788–801.
* equal contribution
47. Chen, P., Teo, D. W. H., Foo, D. X. Y., Derry, H. A., Hayward, B. T., Schulz, K. W., Hayward, C., McKay, T. A., & **Ong, D. C.** (2022). Real-World Effectiveness of a Social-Psychological Intervention Translated from Controlled Trials to Classrooms. *(Nature) npj Science of Learning*, 7 (20).
46. Suresh, V., & **Ong, D. C.** (2022). Using Positive Matching Contrastive Loss with Facial Action Units to mitigate bias in Facial Expression Recognition. In *Proceedings of the 10th International Conference on Affective Computing and Intelligent Interaction (ACII 2022)*.
45. Teo, D. W. H., Ang, Z. Y., & **Ong, D. C.**, (2022). Modeling Causal Inference from Emotional Displays. In *Proceedings of the 44th Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society*, 2200–2206.
44. Goldenberg, A., Schöne, J., Huang, Z., Sweeny, T. D., **Ong, D. C.**, Brady, T. F., Robinson, M. M., Levari, D., Zaki, J., & Gross, J. J. (2022). Amplification in the Evaluation of Multiple Emotional Expressions Over Time. *Nature Human Behaviour*, 6(10), 1408–1416.
43. Houlihan, S. D., **Ong, D. C.**, Cusimano, M., & Saxe, R. (2022). Reasoning about the antecedents of emotions: Bayesian causal inference over an intuitive theory of mind. In *Proceedings of the 44th Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society*, 854–861.
42. Jospe, K., Genzer, S., Mansano, L., **Ong, D. C.**, Zaki, J., Soroker, N., & Perry, A. (2022). Impaired

- empathic accuracy following damage to the left hemisphere. *Biological Psychology*, 172, 108380.
41. Weisz, E., Chen, P., **Ong, D. C.**, Carlson, R. W., Clark, M. D., & Zaki, J. (2022). A Brief Intervention to Motivate Empathy among Middle School Students. *Journal of Experimental Psychology: General*, 151(12), 3144–3153.
 40. **Ong, D. C.** (2021). An Ethical Framework for Guiding the Development of Affectively-Aware Artificial Intelligence. In *Proceedings of the 9th International Conference on Affective Computing and Intelligent Interaction (ACII 2021)*. [Oral Presentation]
[**Best Paper Award**]
 39. **Ong, D. C.**, Soh, H., Zaki, J., & Goodman, N. D. (2021). Applying Probabilistic Programming to Affective Computing. *IEEE Transactions on Affective Computing*, 12(2), 306–317.
[**Best of IEEE Transactions on Affective Computing 2021 Paper Collection**]
 38. **Ong, D. C.**, Wu, Z., Zhi-Xuan, T., Reddan, M., Kahhale, I., Mattek, A., & Zaki, J. (2021). Modeling emotion in complex stories: the Stanford Emotional Narratives Dataset. *IEEE Transactions on Affective Computing*, 12(3), 579–594.
 37. Chen, P.*, **Ong, D. C.***, Ng, J. C., & Coppola, B. P. (2021). Explore, Exploit, and Prune in the Classroom: Strategic Resource Management Behaviors Predict Performance. *AERA Open*, 7(1), 1-14.
* equal contribution
 36. **Ong, D. C.**, Asaba, M., Lim, H. Y., Chen, P., & Gweon, H. (2021). “If only Santa had one more present”: Exploring the development of near-miss counterfactual reasoning. In *Proceedings of the 43rd Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society*.
 35. Lai, Y., Kankanhalli, A., & **Ong, D. C.** (2021). Human-AI Collaboration in Healthcare: A Review and Research Agenda. In *Proceedings of the Hawaii International Conference on System Sciences 2021*.
 34. Nguyen, T.-S., Wu, Z., & **Ong, D. C.** (2021). Attention Uncovers Task-Relevant Semantics in Emotional Narrative Understanding. *Knowledge-Based Systems*, 226, 107162.
 33. Suresh, V., & **Ong, D. C.** (2021). Not all negatives are equal: Label-Aware Contrastive Loss for fine-grained text classification. In *Proceedings of the 2021 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (EMNLP 2021)*.
 32. Suresh, V., & **Ong, D. C.** (2021). Using Knowledge-Embedded Attention to Augment Pre-trained Language Models for Fine-Grained Emotion Recognition. In *Proceedings of the 9th International Conference on Affective Computing and Intelligent Interaction (ACII 2021)*. [Oral Presentation]
 31. Teo, D., & **Ong, D. C.** (2021). Learning from Agentic Actions: Modelling Causal Inference from Intention. In *Proceedings of the 43rd Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society*, 2478–2484.
 30. Wu, Z., & **Ong, D. C.** (2021). Context-Guided BERT for Targeted Aspect-Based Sentiment Analysis. In *Proceedings of the AAAI Conference on Artificial Intelligence*, 35(16), 14094–14102.
 29. Wu, Z., & **Ong, D. C.** (2021). Pragmatically Informative Color Generation by Grounding Contextual Modifiers. In *Proceedings of the Society for Computation in Linguistics*, 4(54), 438–445.
 28. Weisz, E., **Ong, D. C.**, Carlson, R. W., & Zaki, J. (2021). Building Empathy through Motivation-Based Interventions. *Emotion*, 21(5), 990–999
 27. Wu, Z., Kreiss, E., **Ong, D. C.**, & Potts, C. G. (2021). ReaSCAN: Compositional Reasoning in Language Grounding. In *Proceedings of the Neural Information Processing Systems Track on Datasets and Benchmarks (NeurIPS 2021)*.
 26. Jospe, K., Genzer, S., Klein-Selle, N., **Ong, D. C.**, Zaki, J. & Perry, A. (2020). The contribution of linguistic and visual cues to physiological synchrony and empathic accuracy. *Cortex*, 132, 296–

25. Wu, Z., Nguyen, T.-S., & **Ong, D. C.** (2020). Structured Self-Attention Weights Encodes Semantics in Sentiment Analysis. In *Proceedings of the Third BlackboxNLP Workshop on Analyzing and Interpreting Neural Networks for NLP*, 255–264. (EMNLP 2020 Workshop)
24. Zhi-Xuan, T., Soh, H., & **Ong, D. C.** (2020). Factorized Inference in Deep Markov Models for Incomplete Multimodal Time Series. In *Proceedings of the AAAI Conference on Artificial Intelligence*, 34(06), 10334–10341. [Oral Presentation]
23. **Ong, D. C.**, Zaki, J., & Goodman, N. D. (2019). Computational models of emotion inference in Theory of Mind: A review and roadmap. *Topics in Cognitive Science*, 11(2), 338–357.
22. Asaba, M.*, **Ong, D. C.***, & Gweon, H. (2019). Integrating expectations and outcomes: Preschoolers' developing ability to reason about others' emotions. *Developmental Psychology*, 55(8), 1680–1693.
* equal contribution
21. Tan, Z.-X., & **Ong, D. C.** (2019). Bayesian Inference of Social Norms as Shared Constraints on Behavior. In *Proceedings of the 41st Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society*, 2919–2925.
20. Tan, Z.-X.*, Goel, A.*, Nguyen, T.-S.*, & **Ong, D. C.** (2019). A Multimodal LSTM for Predicting Listener Empathic Responses over time. Presented at the *OMG-Empathy Challenge workshop at the 14th IEEE International Conference on Automatic Face and Gesture Recognition (FG) 2019*.
* equal contribution
19. Wu, Z., Zhang, X., Zhi-Xuan, T., Zaki, J. & **Ong, D. C.** (2019). Attending to Emotional Narratives. In *Proceedings of the 8th International Conference on Affective Computing and Intelligent Interaction (ACII 2019)*. [Oral Presentation]
18. Xie, Y., Bodala, I. P., **Ong, D. C.**, Hsu, D., & Soh, H. (2019). Robot Capability and Intention in Trust-based Decisions across Tasks. In *Proceedings of the 14th ACM/IEEE Conference on Human-Robot Interaction (HRI)*, 39–47.
17. **Ong, D. C.**, Goodman, N. D., & Zaki, J. (2018). Happier than thou? A self-enhancement bias in emotion attribution. *Emotion*, 18(1), 116–126.
16. Williams, W. C., Morelli, S. A., **Ong, D. C.**, & Zaki, J. (2018). Interpersonal emotion regulation: Implications for affiliation, perceived support, relationships, and well-being. *Journal of Personality and Social Psychology*, 115(2), 224–254.
15. **Ong, D. C.**, Zaki, J., & Gruber, J. (2017). Increased cooperative behavior across remitted bipolar I disorder and major depression: Insights utilizing a behavioral economic trust game. *Journal of Abnormal Psychology*, 126(1), 1–7.
14. Chen, P., Chavez, O., **Ong, D. C.**, & Gunderson, B. (2017). Strategic Resource Use for Learning: A Self-administered Intervention that Guides Effective Resource Use Enhances Academic Performance. *Psychological Science*, 28(6), 774–785.
13. Morelli, S. A., **Ong, D. C.**, Makati, R., Jackson, M. O., & Zaki, J. (2017). Empathy and well-being correlate with centrality in different social networks. *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences*, 114(37), 9843–9847.
12. **Ong, D. C.***, Asaba, M.*, & Gweon, H. (2016). Young children and adults integrate past expectations and current outcomes to reason about others' emotions. In *Proceedings of the 38th Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society*, 135–140.
* equal contribution
11. **Ong, D. C.**, Zaki, J., & Goodman, N. D. (2016). Emotions in lay explanations of behavior. In *Proceedings of the 38th Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society*, 360–365.

10. Devlin, H. C., Zaki, J., **Ong, D. C.**, & Gruber, J. (2016). Tracking the emotional highs, but missing the lows: Hypomania Risk is associated with positively biased empathic inference. *Cognitive Therapy and Research*, 40(1), 72–79.
9. Nook, E., **Ong, D. C.**, Morelli, S. A., Mitchell, J. P., & Zaki, J. (2016). Prosocial Conformity: Prosocial norms generalize across behavior and empathy. *Personality and Social Psychology Bulletin*, 42(8), 1045–1062.
8. **Ong, D. C.**, Zaki, J., & Goodman, N. D. (2015) Affective Cognition: Exploring lay theories of emotion. *Cognition*, 143. 141–162.
7. **Ong, D. C.**, Goodman, N. D., & Zaki, J. (2015). Near-misses sting even when they are uncontrollable. In *Proceedings of the 37th Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society*, 1775–1780.
6. Phillips, J.*, **Ong, D. C.***, Surtees, A. D. R., Xin, Y., Williams, S., Saxe, R., & Frank, M. C. (2015). A second look at automatic Theory of Mind: reconsidering Kovács, Téglás, and Endress (2010). *Psychological Science*, 26(9), 1353–1367.
* equal contribution
5. Devlin, H. C., Zaki, J., **Ong, D. C.**, & Gruber, J. (2014). Not as Good as You Think? Trait Positive Emotion is Associated with Increased Self-Reported Empathy but Decreased Empathic Performance. *PLOS ONE*, 9 (10), e110470

Previous work in physics and optics

4. Leahy, B. D., Cheng, X., **Ong, D. C.**, Liddell-Watson, C., & Cohen, I. (2013) Enhancing rotational diffusion using oscillatory shear. *Physical Review Letters*, **110**, 228301.
3. **Ong, D. C.**, Solanki, S., Liang, X., & Xu, X. W. (2012). Analysis of laser speckle severity, granularity, and anisotropy using the power spectral density in polar-coordinate representation. *Optical Engineering*, **51**, 054301.
2. Gerbode, S. J., **Ong, D. C.**, Liddell, C. M., & Cohen, I. (2010). Dislocations and vacancies in two-dimensional mixed crystals of spheres and dimers. *Physical Review E*, **82**, 041404.
1. Gerbode, S. J., Agarwal, U., **Ong, D. C.**, Liddell, C. M., Escobedo, F., & Cohen, I. (2010). Glassy dislocation dynamics in 2-D colloidal dimer crystals. *Physical Review Letters*, **105**, 078301.

Invited Talks

24. October 2026. Psychology Department Colloquium, Georgetown University
23. July 2026. Singapore Ministry of Health Office of Healthcare Transformation.
22. June 2026. Kabiller Conference on AI and Empathy. Kellogg School of Management, Northwestern University.
21. June 2026. AI and Social Research: Empathic AI, Metascience, and Methodology. Conference at Penn State University.
20. June 2026. Stanford HAI & AI4MH Policy Workshop on AI and Mental Health. Stanford University.
19. December 2025. Psychology Department Social Area Brownbag. University of California, San Diego.
18. December 2025. Workshop on “Conversational AI & Mental Health: Opportunities and Challenges”, Sanford Institute for Empathy and Compassion, University of California, San Diego
17. November 2025. Psychology Department Colloquium. University of California, Berkeley.

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16. November 2025. Stanford/Anthropic Workshop on “AI Companions and Roleplay”. Stanford University.
15. October 2025. 2nd Princeton Summit on Affective Science, Princeton University.
14. September 2025. Psychology Department Colloquium. Southern Methodist University.
13. May 2025. Management & Operations Department, Kellogg School of Management, Northwestern University.
12. January 2025. Psychology Department Colloquium. Stanford University.
11. November 2024. Affective Science Area Seminar, Department of Psychology, Stanford University.
10. October 2024. Stanford Conference on Emotion Regulation in the Age of AI and LLMs. Stanford University.
9. August 2024. Institute for Pedagogical Innovation, Research, & Excellence. Nanyang Technological University, Singapore. [*publicized to whole University*]
8. July 2024. Center for Research in Child Development. National Institute of Education, Singapore.
7. November 2023. Psychology Department Colloquium, Cal State University, Northridge (CSUN).
6. October 2022. Microsoft Research. [*publicized to whole organization*]
5. February 2022. Ministry of Education School Cluster N5 Meeting, Singapore.
4. February 2020. Social Cognitive Neuroscience Lab Meeting, Department of Brain and Cognitive Sciences, MIT.
3. June 2019. Probabilistic Machine Learning Seminar, Uber AI Labs, San Francisco, USA.
2. April 2017. Computational Cognitive Neuroscience/Moral Psychology Research Lab Meeting, Department of Psychology, Harvard University
1. August 2013. Positive Emotion and Psychopathology Lab Meeting, Department of Psychology, Yale University

At own institution

14. September 2026. Department of Educational Psychology HDCLS Area Colloquium, UT Austin
13. August 2025. Department of Psychology, UT Austin.
12. February 2024. College of Liberal Arts Research Week, UT Austin.
11. October 2023. Texas Robotics Symposium Panelist. UT Austin.
10. October 2022. Developmental Area Seminar, Department of Psychology, UT Austin.
9. October 2022. Social/Personality Area Seminar, Department of Psychology, UT Austin.
8. February 2022. Invited Keynote Panelist on NUS Symposium on Artificial Intelligence in Education, National University of Singapore
7. May 2020. Institute for Applied Learning Sciences and Educational Technology, National University of Singapore.
6. April 2016. Affective Science Area Seminar, Department of Psychology, Stanford University
5. March 2016. Cognition and Neuroscience Area Seminar, Department of Psychology, Stanford University

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4. February 2015. Affective Science Area Seminar, Department of Psychology, Stanford University
3. January 2015. Affective Science Area Seminar, Department of Psychology, Stanford University
2. October 2013. Affective Science Area Seminar, Department of Psychology, Stanford University
1. April 2013. Cognition and Neuroscience Area Seminar, Department of Psychology, Stanford University

Selected Conference Symposia and Talks

Invited Conference Talks

6. Invited panelist on “Artificial Intelligence and Emotional Support” at the Emotion Preconference, at the *Society for Personality and Social Psychology (SPSP 2025)*. Denver, CO, February 2025.
5. Invited panelist at “Meet the Editors” panel, *International Society for Research in Emotions*, (ISRE 2024). Belfast, UK, July 2024.
4. Invited Chair of a panel on “Ethical Affective Computing in Practice” at *Affective Computing and Intelligent Interaction ACII2023*. Cambridge, MA, October 2023.
3. Invited talk at the Affective Computing Preconference at the *International Society for Research in Emotion (ISRE 2022)*. Los Angeles, CA, July 2022.
2. Invited talk at the *Society for Affective Science (SAS 2022)*. Virtual, March 2022. “Critically examining the generalizability of facial expression recognition models.”
1. Invited talk at the Emotion Preconference at the *Society for Personality and Social Psychology (SPSP 2021)*. Virtual, February 2021. “What can AI learn from Affective Science (and vice versa)?”

Organized Workshops and Preconferences

2. Affective Computing (AC@ISRE2024) (<https://sites.google.com/view/acisre2024>)
Preconference at ISRE2024
Organizers: Broekens, J., Girard, J., & Ong, D. C.
1. Interdisciplinary Advanced in Affective Cognition (<https://affcog.github.io>)
Workshop at CogSci2022
Organizers: Wu, Y., Ong, D. C., & Gweon, H.
Contributed Workshop at CogSci 2021

Selected Contributed Conference Talks

1. Ong, D. C., Thejll-Madsen, T., Zhan, H., Gueorguieva, E. S., Suh, J., & Li, J. J. (Mar 2025). Exploring the potential of AI and computational modeling to offer targeted reappraisals. Talk given at the Society for Affective Science 2025, Portland, OR.

Teaching Experience

- The University of Texas at Austin, Department of Psychology*
4. PSY 371T: Text Analysis for Behavioral Data Science
(upper-division undergraduate elective)
(<https://cascoglab.psy.utexas.edu/desmond/teaching/textAnalysis>)
Spring 2026; Spring 2025; Spring 2024; Spring 2023
 3. PSY 371Q: Ethics in Behavioral Data Science
(upper-division undergraduate elective)
(<https://cascoglab.psy.utexas.edu/desmond/teaching/ethics>)
Fall 2026; Fall 2025; Fall 2024; Fall 2023; Spring 2023

National University of Singapore, Department of Information Systems and Analytics

2. IS4152 / IS5452: Affective Computing (Final-year undergraduate elective / Masters elective).
[\[https://is4152.github.io/\]](https://is4152.github.io/)
Semester 1, Academic Year 2021/2022
Semester 1, Academic Year 2020/2021
1. BT1101: Introduction to Business Analytics (First-year undergraduate statistics; taught in R).
Semester 1, Academic Year 2021/2022. Enrolment: 350
Semester 2, Academic Year 2020/2021. Enrolment: 120
Semester 1, Academic Year 2019/2020. Enrolment: 280

Pre-tenure-track Teaching Assistant experience

Stanford University, Department of Psychology

5. Psych 204: Computation and Cognition: The Probabilistic Approach (Graduate), Spring 2015.
Instructor: Noah Goodman
4. Psych 254: Lab in Experimental Methods (Graduate), Winter 2015. Instructor: Michael Frank
3. Psych 90: Intro to Clinical Psychology (Undergraduate), Fall 2014. Instructor: Ian Gotlib
2. Psych 80: Intro to Personality and Affective Science (Undergraduate), Spring 2014. Instructor: Jeanne Tsai
1. Psych 1: Intro to Psychology (Undergraduate); Fall 2013, Winter 2014. Instructor: James Gross, Jamil Zaki, Bridgette Hard

Advising and Mentorship

For some of my advisees while I was in Singapore, I provide their last name/surname/family name first as is the custom in Singapore and some other cultures. These are indicated with an underline.

Postdoctoral scholar advising

Eliana Hadjiandreou. 2024 – 2026.

First placement: Assistant Professor of Marketing, University of Cyprus

Graduate student advising

Mona Xue (UT Ph.D. Student in Psychology). 2024 – present

Emma Gueorgieva (UT Ph.D. Student in Psychology). 2023 – present

Varsha Suresh (NUS Ph.D. Student in Computer Science, supervised 2020 – 2023, graduated May 2023).

Dennis Teo (NUS Ph.D. Student in Information Systems and Analytics, supervised 2020 – 2022).

Phoebe Chua (NUS Ph.D. Student in Information Systems and Analytics, supervised 2020 – 2022).

Gerard Yeo (NUS Ph.D. Student in Data Science, supervised 2021 – 2022).

Zhengxuan Wu (Stanford Masters Student in Symbolic Systems). Mar 2018 – Aug 2022.

First placement: Ph.D. student in Computer Science at Stanford

Currently: Research Scientist at Google Deepmind

Full-time Research Assistants (and equivalent)

Yuhui Chen (Visiting Ph.D. student from the University of Manchester), visited UT Fall 2026.

Purna Zaman (UT Lab Coordinator), July 2023 – June 2025.

Yoon Kyung Lee (Visiting Ph.D. student from Seoul National University), visited UT for 2023–2024.

Lim Hui Yan (NUS Full-Time Research Assistant), Aug 2020 – May 2022.

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Tan Zhi-Xuan (A*STAR post-baccalaureate Research Engineer), Jun 2018 – Aug 2019.
First placement: Ph.D. Student at MIT EECS & Brain and Cognitive Sciences;
Currently: Assistant Professor of Computer Science, National University of Singapore.

Honors Thesis / Final Year Projects (FYP) Students

Emily Jia-Xun Yang (UT Psychology Honors Thesis, Jan 2023 – Dec 2023)
Kong Yan San (NUS Business Analytics undergraduate, FYP, Aug 2020 – May 2021)
***Yan San won the SoC Outstanding Computing Project Prize AY2020/2021**
Darren Lee (NUS Computer Science undergraduate, FYP, Aug 2020 – May 2021)
Terence Lim (NUS Business Analytics undergraduate, FYP, Aug 2019 – May 2020)
***Terence won the NUS Outstanding Undergraduate Researcher Prize AY2019/2020**

Undergraduate Research Assistants / Interns / Summer Students

Viswonathan Manoranjan (UNC Chapel Hill MS Student, May – Aug 2026)
Ryan Truong (UT undergraduate and research assistant, Oct 2023 – May 2025)
Currently: Ph.D. student in Psychology at Harvard
Joseph Kwon (Yale undergraduate, Jun 2020 – Aug 2020; now Lab Manager at MIT)
Ng Hui Xin (Vassar graduate, Jan 2019 – Aug 2019; now Ph.D. Student at UC San Diego)
Lu Hui (Columbia undergraduate, Jun 2019 – Aug 2019)
Rucha Kelkar (MIT undergraduate, Jun 2019 – Aug 2019)
Pu Ruohan (Cambridge undergraduate, Jul 2019 – Aug 2019)

Ph.D. Dissertation Committees (as Examiner)

Nyx Ng (UT Psychology, defended 2026)
Shaina Munin (UT Psychology, defended 2025)
Hannah Lunkenheimer (UT Psychology, defended 2025)
Ajna Kertesz (UT Psychology, defended 2025)
Jacqueline Duong (UT Psychology, proposal defended Spring '25)
Hongli Zhan (UT Linguistics, defended Spring '26)
Yejin Cho (UT Linguistics, defended Spring '26)
Alexis Smith-Flores (UC San Diego Psychology, defended Spring '25)
Ben Steward (Australian National University, Fall 2026)
Luo Kai (NUS Information Systems and Analytics, graduated 2020)
Vo Thanh Vihn (NUS Computer Science, graduated 2022)
Zheng Chenxu (NUS Information Systems and Analytics, graduated 2022)

Professional Service

National-Level Service

Member, Technical Advisory Group, National Robotics Programme, Singapore, 2021–2022
Contributor, Foundational Research Capabilities (FRC) report on General AI, 2022 (subtopic: Affective Computing), commissioned by the National Research Foundation, Singapore.

Professional Societies and Conferences

Bolded indicate significant effort

The Cognitive Science Society (CogSci)
Society Conference Committee, 2023 – present
Conference Co-Chair, CogSci 2023
Communications Chair, CogSci 2020

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(Senior) Program Committee Member (i.e., meta-reviewer), CogSci 2020–2022, 2025

The Association for the Advancement of Affective Computing (AAAC), and the annual conference, IEEE Affective Computing and Intelligent Interaction (ACII)

AAAC Management Board, 2024 – present [elected to a 6-year term]

Reviewer, AAAC Dissertation Award, ACII 2024

Conference Ethics Chair, ACII 2023

Program Committee Co-Chair, ACII 2022

Workshop and Special Track Co-Chair, and Senior Program Committee Member, ACII 2021

The Society for Affective Science (SAS)

Awards Committee, 2026 – present

Conference Program Co-Chair, SAS 2026 (part of SAS Board as a Director at Large)

Membership & Outreach Committee, 2025–2026

Institutional Academic Service

At the University of Texas at Austin

Research Excellence Committee, Department of Psychology, 2026 – present

Executive Committee, Department of Psychology, 2025 – 2026

Colloquium Committee, Department of Psychology, 2023 – 2024

At the National University of Singapore

School Ethics Review Committee, School of Computing, 2019 – 2022

Publicity Committee, Department of Information Systems and Analytics, 2021 – 2022

Graduate Admissions, Department of Information Systems and Analytics, 2019 – 2022

At Stanford University (while a Ph.D. student)

Faculty Search Committee, Cognitive Area, Department of Psychology, 2014 – 2015

Graduate Admissions Committee, Affective Science Area, Department of Psychology, 2013 – 2014

Area Seminar Committee, Department of Psychology: Cognitive Area, 2014–2015 & Affective Science Area, 2013 – 2014

Reviewing activities

Associate Editor, *Cognitive Science*, 2023 – 2026

Board of Reviewers, *Cognitive Science*, 2021 – 2024

Guest Editor, *IEEE Transactions on Affective Computing*, 2023

Grant Panelist: U.S. National Science Foundation (NSF), 2026

Ad-hoc reviewer:

Grant Agencies: U.S. National Science Foundation (NSF); U.S. Army Research Office (ARO);

Natural Sciences and Engineering Research Council (NSERC) of Canada;

Social Sciences and Humanities Research Council (SSHRC) of Canada;

United Kingdom Research and Innovation (UKRI);

Israel Science Foundation (ISF); John Templeton Foundation; Huo Family Foundation

Journals: *Nature*; *Nature Human Behaviour*; *Nature Communications*; *Nature Reviews Psychology*;

Nature Mental Health; *Nature Computational Science*; *Nature Machine Intelligence*; *Nature Mental Health*; *Science Robotics*; *Communications Psychology*;

Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences; *The Lancet Psychiatry*;

Psychological Science; *Psychological Review*;

Trends in Cognitive Science; *Cognition*; *Cognitive Science*; *Cognitive Psychology*; *Emotion*;

Journal of Experimental Psychology: General; *Personality and Social Psychological Bulletin*;

Perspectives on Psychological Science; *Developmental Psychology*;

Emotion Review; *Social Psychological and Personality Science*;

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Advances in Methods and Practices in Psychological Science;
British Journal of Psychology; Collabra Psychology;
IEEE Transactions on Affective Computing; IEEE Transactions on Cybernetics;
Computer Speech and Language; Journal of Neuroscience, Psychology, and Economics; Optical Engineering

Cognitive Science / Psychology Conferences: *Cognitive Science Society (CogSci 2015–2026),*
Society for Philosophy and Psychology (SPP 2016),
International Society for Research in Emotions (ISRE 2022),
Society for Affective Science (SAS 2023, 2024)

Computer Science Conferences: *ACL Rolling Review (2026),*
Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (EMNLP 2015, 2020)

***nominated as an Outstanding Reviewer for EMNLP2020**

Association for the Advancement of Artificial Intelligence (AAAI 2019),
Human-Robot Interaction (HRI 2019–2021),
International Conference on Robotics and Automation (ICRA 2021)

Information Systems Conferences: *International Conference on Information Systems (ICIS 2020)*
ACM Computer-Supported Cooperative Work and Social Computing (CSCW 2021)